Experiment 12
Creating Reports and Dashboards for Data Visualization in Zoho Creator

Aim
To create different reports and a dashboard in Zoho Creator to display the data of the "Leave Management" application in a clear and visual form.

Objectives
- To understand the types of reports available in Zoho Creator.
- To create reports with filters and sorting.
- To create charts such as bar and pie charts.
- To combine charts and reports into a single dashboard page.

Requirements

Item	Details
Software	Zoho Creator account
Application	"Leave Management" application with at least 10 sample leave records
Browser	Chrome, Edge or Firefox

Introduction
A report shows the records stored through a form. A good report helps a manager to understand the data quickly. A dashboard brings the important reports and charts together on one screen, so the user does not have to open many reports. Zoho Creator provides several ready-made report types, and the type should be selected according to the kind of data.

Report Types

Report Type	Description	Suitable For
List	Shows records in rows with details	General viewing and editing of records
Grid	Shows records in a spreadsheet-like table	Quick editing of many records
Calendar	Shows records on dates	Leave dates and schedules
Kanban	Shows records as cards in columns by status	Pending, Approved and Rejected tracking
Summary / Chart	Groups data and shows totals as tables or charts	Comparison and analysis

Sample Data Used

Department	Leave Type	Number of Records	Total Days
HR	Casual	3	5
Sales	Sick	4	9
Production	Earned	2	10
Accounts	Casual	3	4

Procedure

Part A: Creating Reports

1. Open the application in edit mode and click "Add new component", then select "Report".
2. Select the "Leave Request" form as the source and choose the List type.
3. Select the columns to be shown, such as Employee Name, Department, Leave Type, From Date, To Date and Status.
4. Add a filter so that only records with the status "Pending" are shown and name this report "Pending Requests".
5. Create a Calendar report using the From Date and To Date fields.
6. Create a Kanban report grouped by the Status field.

Part B: Creating Charts

1. Create a new Summary or Chart report from the Leave Request form.
2. Group the data by Department and select the count of records as the value; choose a bar chart.
3. Create another chart grouped by Leave Type and select a pie chart.
4. Give clear titles to the charts and save them.

Part C: Creating the Dashboard

1. Add a new Page and name it "Dashboard".
2. Drag the bar chart, the pie chart and the Pending Requests report into the page.
3. Add text boxes as headings for each part and resize the elements to fit the screen.
4. Save the page, set it as the home screen if required, and open the live view to check it.

Observations

Component Created	Type	Result Observed
Pending Requests	List report with filter	Only records with Pending status shown

Component Created	Type	Result Observed
Leave Calendar	Calendar report	Leave periods appear on the correct dates
Status Board	Kanban report	Cards shown under Pending, Approved and Rejected
Leaves by Department	Bar chart	Sales department had the highest number of leave days
Leaves by Type	Pie chart	Share of each leave type clearly visible
Dashboard	Page	All charts and reports displayed on one screen

Tips for a Good Dashboard

- Show only the most important information; too many charts make the page confusing.
- Use a bar chart for comparison and a pie chart for share of a total.
- Write a clear title and label for every chart.
- Place the most important chart at the top left of the page.
- Check the dashboard on a mobile screen also.

Result

Different reports, two charts and a dashboard page were created for the Leave Management application. The data was displayed correctly and could be understood easily from the dashboard.

Conclusion

Reports and dashboards turn stored data into useful information. Filters help to focus on the required records, and charts make comparison easy. A dashboard helps managers to take quick decisions without opening each report separately.